AJP Position Statement

Towards a cruelty-free and sustainable fashion industry

The Animal Justice Party Aotearoa NZ envisions a future where fashion is free from animal exploitation and environmental harm. We recognise that the use of animal-derived materials such as leather, wool, fur, down and exotic skins perpetuates cruel and unsustainable practices. Animals exploited for fashion, like those farmed for food or fibre, are sentient beings with their own personhood and rights, and their lives must not be commodified for human use

Key Positions:

1. **Complete Phase-Out:** Ban on production, sale and import of:
   - Leather and exotic skins
   - Wool and possum fur
   - Down and feathers
   - Animal-derived accessories (bone, horn, pearls)
2. **Industry Transition Support:**
   - Financial assistance for businesses transitioning to ethical alternatives
   - Research funding for sustainable materials
   - Training programs for workers in affected industries
3. **Te Tiriti Partnership:**
   - Consultation with Māori textile experts
   - Support for traditional, cruelty-free fibre practices
   - Investment in Māori-led sustainable textile initiatives
4. **Interim Measures:**
   - Mandatory labeling of animal-derived materials
   - Import restrictions from countries with poor animal welfare
   - Transparency requirements for production methods